

utable antivirus researchers to be a very bad, even dangerous, idea, and should be avoided at all costs.

### **Anti-heuristic**

Anti-heuristic techniques are efforts by virus writers to avoid their code being detected as a possible new virus by heuristic detection. What works depends on heuristics approaches of different scanners, but some code obfuscation techniques appear clearly anti-heuristic.

### **Appender**

A virus that inserts a copy of its code at the end of its victim file is known as an appender or appending virus. (c.f. Cavity Infector, Companion Virus, Overwriter, Prepender)

### **Armoured Virus**

Viruses that use special tricks to make tracing them in a debugger and/or disassembling them difficult are said to be 'armoured'. The purpose of armouring is primarily to hinder virus analysts reaching a complete understanding of the virus' code. An early example of an armoured virus is Whale.

### **AV Killer**

Any hacker tool intended to disable a user's anti-virus software to help elude detection. Some will also disable personal firewalls.

### **Backdoor**

A program that surreptitiously allows access to a computer's resources (files, network connections, configuration information etc.) via a network connection is known as a backdoor or remote access trojan. Note that such functionality is often included in legitimate software designed and intended to allow such access.

### **Bait File, Goat File, Decoy File**

Some generic approaches to virus detection create 'dummy' program files which are written to the drives of the machines being monitored. These files are regularly checked for modification, or created, checked and then deleted. Such files are sometimes called 'goat files', 'decoy files' or 'bait files' because they are not intend-